Arizona Voters Are Worried About Water

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In Arizona, many voters have a new top worry before this fall's **midterm elections**. It is water.

Arizona is in a long **drought**. That means it has had much less rain than usual for a long time. **Canals** carry water to the desert city of Phoenix, but that water is getting harder to come by. This summer, the federal government made deep cuts to the Colorado River water that Arizona cities get.

A recent **survey** from a group called the Center for the Future of Arizona found that, for the first time, water is voters' top concern.

Candidates now get more questions about how they will protect the state's water. Democrat Amish Shah, who is running for a U.S. House seat, said Arizona should save water and stop using it for **data centers**. His Republican opponent, Jay Feely, said the economy is still the top issue, but water is a big concern too.

One analysis found that farming uses about 75 percent of Arizona's water. **Data centers** use only a small share.

Word Treasure

drought -- A long time with much less rain than normal.

midterm elections -- Elections in the middle of a president's term, when people vote for leaders like members of Congress.

Canals -- Canals are long ditches built to carry water from one place to another.

survey -- A list of questions asked to many people to find out what they think.

data centers -- Big buildings full of computers that run websites and apps.

Background you need

Arizona is a hot, dry desert state, so it gets much of its water from rivers like the Colorado River.

When there is a long drought, rivers carry less water for homes, farms and businesses.

Before elections, voters tell leaders which problems matter most to them.

Break it down

WHO: Arizona voters, the Center for the Future of Arizona, and candidates Amish Shah and Jay Feely

WHAT: A survey found water is now the top worry for Arizona voters before the midterm elections

WHERE: Arizona, including the desert city of Phoenix

WHY: A long drought and cuts to Colorado River water mean there is less water to go around

Why it matters

Everyone needs water to drink, wash and grow food, so how leaders protect it affects kids and families every day.

Test what you remember

1. What is the new top worry for many Arizona voters?

- (A) Snow
- (B) Sports
- (C) Water
- (D) Toys

2. What does drought mean?

- (A) A big snowstorm
- (B) A very windy day
- (C) A flood
- (D) Much less rain than usual for a long time

3. Which desert city gets water from canals?

- (A) Denver
- (B) Phoenix
- (C) Seattle
- (D) Boston

4. Whose water did the federal government cut for Arizona cities?

- (A) The Colorado River's
- (B) The Atlantic Ocean's
- (C) The Mississippi River's
- (D) The Great Lakes'

5. What did Amish Shah say Arizona should stop using water for?

- (A) Swimming pools
- (B) Data centers
- (C) Farms
- (D) Schools

6. About how much of Arizona's water does farming use?

- (A) About 75 percent
- (B) About 5 percent
- (C) About 30 percent
- (D) All of it

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: D 3: B 4: A 5: B 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Amish Shah (Democrat): Arizona should save water and stop using it for data centers.

2. Jay Feely (Republican): The economy is still the top issue, but water is a big concern too.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):